Phocas.

Budgeting & Forecasting

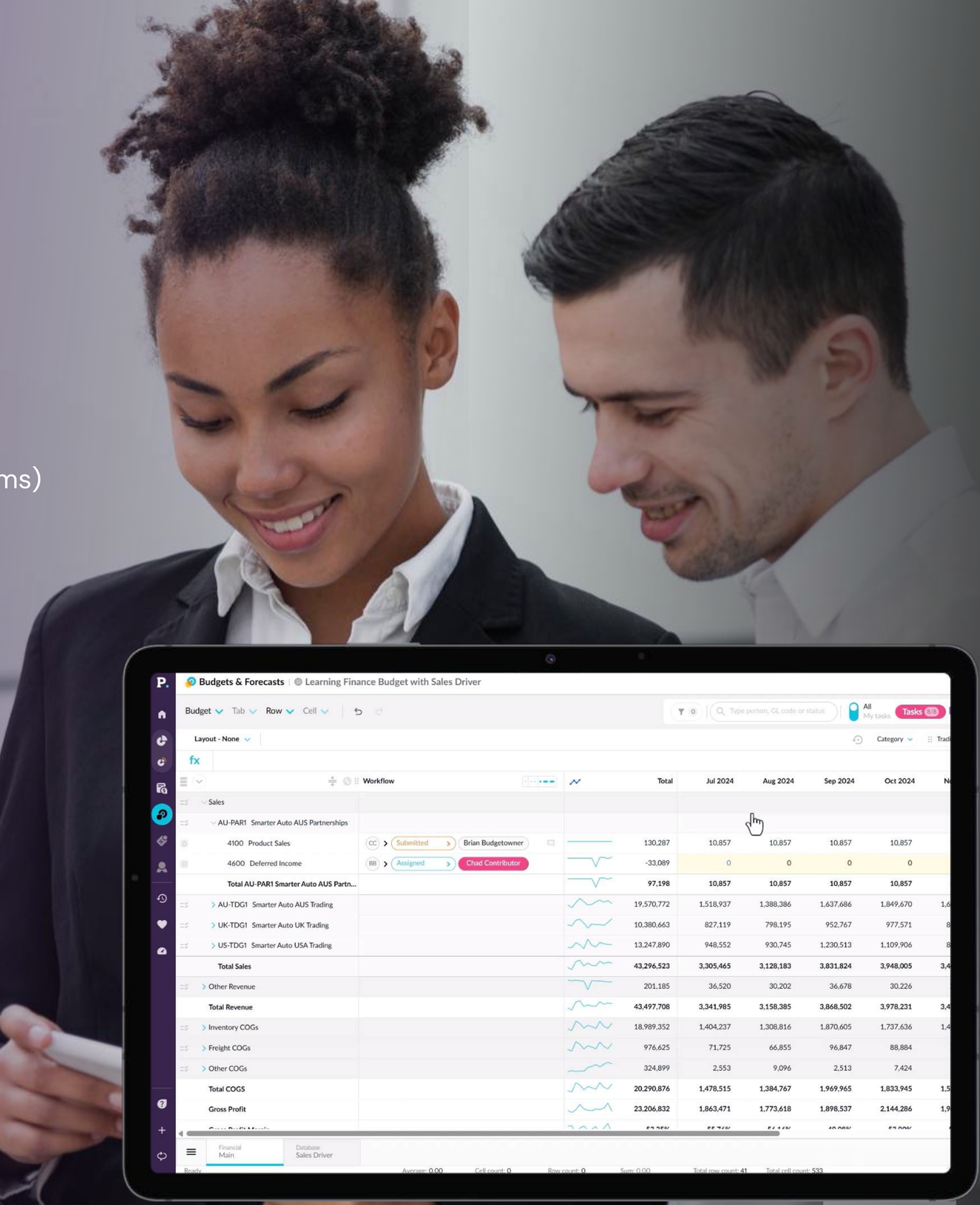
Role: Senior UX Designer

Environment: B2B SaaS (finance & operations teams)
Users: CFOs, Controllers, Operations Managers
Scope: UX strategy, UI design, design system
Team: PM + Eng squad (7 engineers)
Stage: Growth-stage SaaS

Christchurch, New Zealand
Aug 2020 – Sep 2022

OVERVIEW

As a Senior UX Designer, I focused on improving forecasting workflows, interaction clarity, and decision confidence for finance teams.



LUIS SUAREZ

CORE PROBLEM

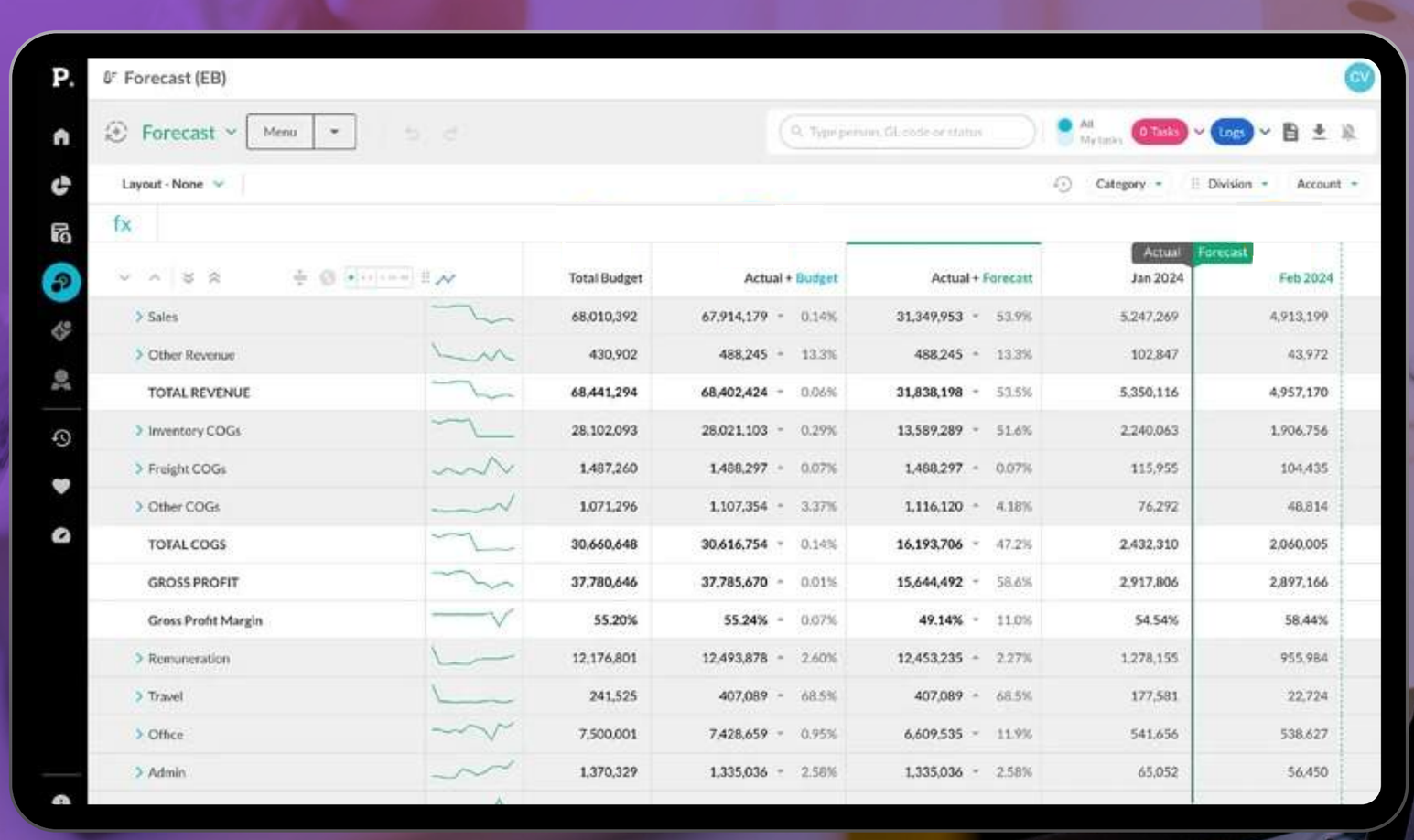
- We learned users export data into spreadsheets
- Users struggled with disconnected workflows
- Finance teams reported version control issues
- We observed high cognitive load in planning scenarios

LUIS SUAREZ

KEY UX DESIGN CONTRIBUTION

Forecasting Switch ↔

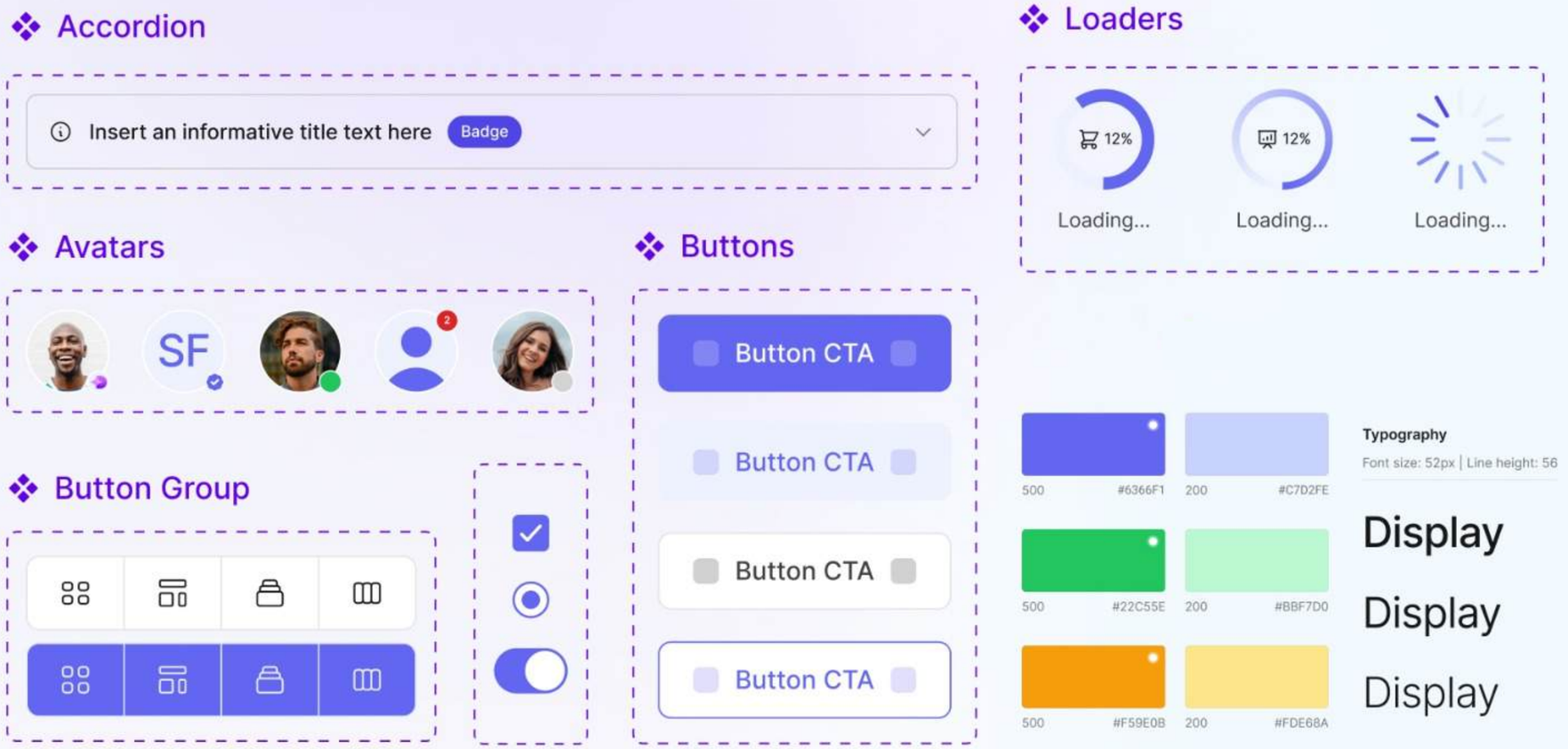
I designed an interaction pattern that allowed users to move between forecasting modes without losing context or confidence.



LUIS SUAREZ

Design System & DesignOps

- Evangelized and validated design system principles through shipped product work and stakeholder alignment.
- Standardised data tables and filters.
- Established scalable UI components.
- Collaborated closely with engineering.



Research & Validation

I participated in usability testing, synthesized findings, and iterated designs based on user feedback.

- Finance professional interviews
- Expert consultations
- Data-driven usability testing
- Iterative prototype validation

IMPACT

- Revenue acceleration through integrated budgeting and forecasting adoption.
- Operational cost reduction via automation & reduced manual reporting.

The integration of **budgeting and forecasting** transformed Phocas into an enterprise-grade intelligence platform. This product evolution contributed to Phocas' market positioning and long-term value creation, culminating in a $500M acquisition by a US-based investment fund, validating the platform's enterprise impact, scalability, and commercial relevance.



What I learned

I learned to evangelize scalable design standards by tying UX consistency directly to business impact and user trust.

LUIS SUAREZ